

Uninstalling Linux

Q A friend of mine installed Mandrake Linux 8.2 on his PC, but later tried to use an HP recovery CD to return to Windows. The Linux installation was on the only partition on the disk and the recovery CD couldn't work, as it could no longer access this. I tried deleting the partitions but was unsuccessful. Kindly help me return to Windows.

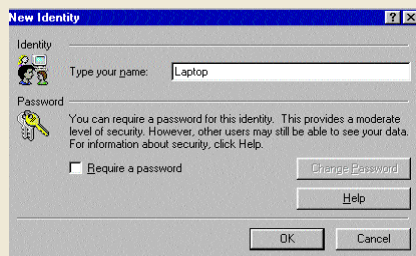
Rahul Srinivasan

Via e-mail

A You can boot to Linux, login as root and use the Fdisk tool to delete the Linux partitions. Alternatively, you can boot using a Windows Startup disk and use the DOS-based Fdisk. If you are using the Linux Fdisk utility, you can type *m* at the prompt to get help. Type *p* to display partition information and Type *d* to delete partitions, upon which you will be prompted for the partition number you want to delete. Delete all Linux partitions one at a time. Type *w* to commit the changes. Enter *q* to quit Fdisk. Reboot the machine using a DOS bootable disk and use the DOS Fdisk tool to create FAT32 partitions. You will have to restart after creating the partitions and format them. From here, you can use the HP Recovery CD or a Windows installation disc to install Windows.

Two PCs, one mailbox

Q I use a desktop and a laptop for accessing e-mail and need to synchro-



Adding a new identity in Outlook Express

nise them often. I would like to have all the e-mail in one place—move the mail from my laptop to the desktop, while maintaining the ones already there. How is this possible? I use Outlook Express 5 and Windows 98 SE on both machines.

Michael Jeyabalan

Via e-mail

A There is no direct way to do this in Outlook Express, but there are a few workarounds. The easiest thing to do would be to create a new identity (*File > Identities > Add New Identity*). Outlook Express stores each identity's mailbox files in separate folders (in C:\Windows\Application Data\Identities), so to synchronise the laptop with the desktop, you would have to simply replace these files on the desktop PC. However, switching identities can get irritating over time. Another thing you can do is create separate folders for e-mail from the laptop and, as above, replace the files for these folders from the laptop. Again, if you do not wish

to store the mail this way, you can use these folders as temporary holders—you can select all the e-mail in a folder and simply drag them to the folder where they are actually meant to be stored.

Dual booting Windows

Q I have an 8 GB hard disk with one 2 GB FAT partition and rest as an NTFS partition. I had Windows NT 4.0 Workstation installed on drive C. Later I installed Windows 95, now I can't boot to Windows NT. I no longer get the option to start Windows NT as I used to earlier. Is there any chance of recovering it?

Nirav Patel

Via e-mail

A The Windows NT Flex Boot Loader has been overwritten by the Windows 95 installation, but don't worry, it's possible to restore this and have a dual-boot option. Boot the computer using the Windows NT Setup boot disk. You will soon be prompted for Setup Disk 2. On the setup options, press [R] to repair the installation. You will now get four repair options. Select the option to Inspect Boot Sector and continue. The Windows NT Flex Boot Loader will be restored on completing the repair. You may need to edit the c:\boot.ini file to include information about the Windows 95 installation.

A Windows 2000 has much stricter consistency checks on all hardware devices than earlier versions of Windows. It probably does not recognise the Linux file system and thus shows the inconsistency error. However, since it also cannot read that partition at all, it fortunately does not check it either—if it did, it would try to fix it and your Linux installation would be corrupted.

SCSI interrupt error

Q I have a Dell PC with a Pentium 4 1.8 GHz processor, 512 MB RAM, a GeForce3 TI200 graphics card and a SoundBlaster Live! soundcard. The OS is Windows XP. I would like to know how to view the output from the PC on a TV

without using a TV Out card. Also, I have a 16x CD-RW drive using a SCSI card. However, I get an I/O interrupt error during startup. Can this be solved? Is there anyway of taking a backup of the address book in Outlook Express?

Manish Golder

Via e-mail

A There are external TV Out boxes using which you can connect the monitor connector from the graphics card to the TV. The SCSI card could be conflicting with one of the PCI slots for a free interrupt. It may be possible to get rid of the interrupt error by changing the BIOS settings. As the machine boots,

press the [Delete] key to enter the BIOS setup. Under PnP/PCI configuration, set the configuration settings to Auto and enable PnP OS Installed. All devices should now be assigned free interrupts automatically and you should stop receiving the error. To backup the Outlook Express address book, look for *.wab files on your hard disk and copy them.



Send your computing problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write to Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar, MIDC, Nerul-400 706, and we may answer it here!